Riya Kona

Student at Case Western Reserve University

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EDUCATION

Case Western Reserve University
Bachelor of Arts in Biology, Minor in Economics, Masters of Science in Biostatistics Integrated Program (3+1)

- GPA: 3.9
- Expected Graduation: May 2028
- Coursework includes: Healthcare Economics, Calculus for Life Sciences, Microbiology, Plant Genomics and Proteomics, Genes & Evolution
- Currently taking: Statistical Methods I, Data Management and Statistical Programming

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Software: R, SAS, SQL, and Excel
- Laboratory: PCR and gel electrophoresis

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Dental Shadowing | August 2026 - Current
Pinnacle Dentistry

- Shadow Dr. Fink, a general dentist, observing patient care, clinical workflow, and dental procedures in a private practice setting

Dental Assistant | April 2026 - August 2026
Torrey Dental Care

- Assisted chairside during restorative, preventive, and surgical procedures using four-handed dentistry techniques
- Took and processed dental radiographs while ensuring patient comfort and adherence to safety protocols

Shadowing and Orthodontic Assistant | May - August 2025
Senestraro Family Orthodontics

- Assisted orthodontist during patient appointments, including chairside support for bracket placement, adjustments, and retainer fittings
- Prepared treatment rooms by sterilizing instruments and maintaining infection control protocols

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Assistant | May 2026 - Current
Lewin Lab at Case Western Reserve University

- Prepared nutrient media, poured agar plates, and cultured bacteria
- Performed Reflectoquant assays to quantify metabolites as part of a larger project with a Ph.D. student investigating interactions between oral streptococcal strains and A. actinomycetemcomitans in localized aggressive periodontitis
- Presented at Summer Intersections and the Annual Department of Pathology Retreat

Student Research Intern | June - August 2025
OHSU Knight Cancer Research Institute, CEDAR, Ngo Lab

- Investigated the impact of DNA length on phase separation; presented poster at OHSU symposium
- Performed precise sample handling and preparation of biological specimens, including plasma and cell-free DNA
- Conducted serial dilutions and volumetric measurements using micropipettes

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Volunteer | November 2025 - September 2026
Cleveland Clinic

- Assisted patients with mobility needs, including transporting patients via wheelchairs to appointments
- Supported patient check-in by guiding individuals through registration and appointment processes

Volunteer | November 2025 - Current
MedWish Dental

- Assisted in a free community clinic serving uninsured and underinsured patients
- Developed strong patient communication skills in a high-need clinical environment

Volunteer | September - December 2025
Transplant House Cleveland

- Assisted with organization and household tasks to support residents during recovery and treatment

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Treasurer | April 2025 - Current
Pre-Dental Society

- Managed the organization's budget and funding, ensuring accurate tracking of expenses
- Collaborated with executive board members to hold professional events, workshops, and guest speakers for pre-dental students and the Greater Cleveland community

Hospitality Chair | March 2026 - Current
Naach Di Cleveland

- Coordinate hospitality operations for a large-scale intercollegiate nonprofit dance competition hosting hundreds of participants and attendees
- Manage logistics for visiting teams including hotel accommodations, meals, transportation coordination, and participant experience
- Write grant proposals and sponsorship outreach materials to support event funding and organizational initiatives

Associate Justice | September 2025 - Current
Panhellenic Board

- Served on the Panhellenic judicial board, reviewing cases related to policy compliance and conduct

Greek Life Officer | March 2026 - Current
MeTooCWRU

- Collaborate with sororities and fraternities to promote education surrounding consent, healthy relationships, and interpersonal safety
- Coordinate outreach initiatives and engagement efforts between #MeToo CWRU and the Greek Life community

Member | March 2025 - Current
Alpha Gamma Delta

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Front Desk Assistant and Peer Tutoring Monitor | August 2026 - Current
Academic Resources, Case Western Reserve University

- Work the front desk for Academic Resources
- Monitor peer tutoring appointments to confirm scheduled sessions are held

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- **Jonathon D. Lewis Scholar | 2025** - PSI Program at Oregon Health and Science University
- **1st Place at State Leadership Conference: Dental Science | 2024** - Health Occupations Students of America
- **Dean's High Honors | All Semesters** - Case Western Reserve University
- **CPR, BLS, AED Certificate | 2026** - Case Western Reserve University Emergency Medical Services
- **Radiation Health and Safety Certificate | 2024** - Dental Assisting National Board
- **Dental Assistant Training Completion | 2024** - Oregon Academy of General Dentistry Foundation